



Grant Thornton

STAKEHOLDER ANALYSIS USING POWER/INTEREST GRID REPORT

Team-2

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1. Introduction

The Week-3 “**Prospective Client Prioritisation & Strategic Targeting**” activity is focused on evaluating, ranking, and selecting the highest-value potential clients for Grant Thornton China using a structured relevance and power interest assessment framework. This stage marks a turning point in the internship, moving from broad research and analytical groundwork toward targeted decision-making that will guide future business development and outreach efforts.

During **Week-1**, extensive secondary research was conducted to identify credible directories, databases, and regulatory sources capable of listing organisations with verified operations in Shanghai and Beijing. The outcome was a consolidated resource ecosystem that allowed the team to confidently identify legitimate law firms, private equity firms, and multinational corporations (MNCs) that fit Grant Thornton China’s strategic profile. This ensured that all future analysis was grounded in accuracy, reliability, and city-level relevance.

In **Week-2**, the focus shifted from resource discovery to deeper organisational understanding. Through use-case analysis and retention-strategy mapping for selected sample clients, the team examined how Grant Thornton’s forensic advisory, compliance, and investigation capabilities intersect with the operational risks faced by global companies in China. This stage clarified “why each client matters” by identifying sector-specific risks, regulatory pain points, internal control gaps, and opportunities where GT’s services directly address client needs.



Week-3 bridges these two phases.

Building on the verified resource foundation (Week-1) and the analytical insights about client needs (Week-2), Week-3 aims to prioritise potential clients using measurable criteria; such as China exposure, risk sensitivity, industry relevance, compliance complexity, and potential for long-term engagement. A **power–interest matrix**, combined with a **relevance scoring model**, will be used to differentiate between high-priority strategic accounts and lower-value prospects.

Our objectives in Week-3:

- **Evaluating potential clients** using Week-1 research outputs and Week-2 use-case relevance.
- **Applying a structured scoring framework** to assess client suitability based on industry risk, China presence, compliance needs, and engagement potential.
- **Conducting a power–interest analysis** to determine which clients offer the highest strategic value and long-term relationship potential.
- **Prioritising and shortlisting high-value clients** that best align with Grant Thornton China's forensic and advisory service capabilities.
- **Creating a validated client selection foundation** to guide Week-4 outreach strategy and communication planning.

Overall, Week-3 ensures that the final client list is not only accurate and well-researched, but also strategically aligned with Grant Thornton China's service offerings and market positioning. This will set the stage for a focused approach to business development, ensuring that future outreach efforts target organisations where GT can deliver the most impact and achieve strong relationship growth.

2. Key Relevance Metrics for Grant Thornton China

In order to shortlist potential clients who are most **relevant and valuable** to Grant Thornton China's Forensic Advisory practice, certain **relevance metrics** must be considered. These metrics help identify organisations with a high likelihood of requiring forensic, compliance, and risk-focused services particularly useful in environments with regulatory scrutiny and complex cross-border operations.

A. Industry Risk Exposure

Certain industries have inherently higher risks of regulatory violation, fraud, corruption, financial misreporting and compliance failure. Sectors such as finance, private equity, real estate,

technology, and global supply chains often face heightened fraud and compliance risks, leading to greater demand for forensic and investigative advisory support. Forensic practitioners are routinely engaged to detect irregularities and support investigations in such high-risk environments. ([StoneTurn](#))

Key points:

- High fraud/AML risk sectors
Impact of regulatory pressure on financial crime exposure
- Industries with complex transaction structures

B. China Operational Complexity

Clients with major operations in China deal with multifaceted governance and compliance requirements due to overlapping local and national laws (e.g., cybersecurity, anti-corruption, taxation, foreign investment controls). Organisations with sprawling China footprints or regional business units face greater complexity in internal control landscapes, which raises their need for specialised forensic and regulatory advisory. ([StoneTurn](#))

Key points:

- Number and scale of business units in China
- Complexity of local regulatory landscapes
- Cross-border operational structures

C. Compliance Pressure Level

Firms subject to frequent or evolving compliance requirements whether from anti-money laundering (AML), anti-bribery laws, ESG disclosures, or financial reporting standards are more likely to seek continuous forensic and compliance support. Forensic advisory teams help clients navigate compliance frameworks and mitigate liability risk under complex regimes. ([EY](#))

Key points:

- History of regulatory enforcement actions
- Frequency of compliance changes impacting operations
- Level of public reporting obligations

D. Presence in Beijing / Shanghai

Grant Thornton China's mandate requires shortlisted clients to have an operational presence in either Shanghai or Beijing - two of China's most critical business hubs. These cities host leading

financial institutions, multinational headquarters, PE/VC offices and legal practices that face concentrated regulatory and market pressures. ([Neotas](#))

Key points:

- Physical office or registered entity in Shanghai/Beijing
- Market engagement intensity in China
- Strategic importance of regional headquarters

E. Global Footprint

A client's global footprint reflects the complexity and scale of their cross-border operations, often increasing exposure to multi-jurisdictional compliance issues, international standards, and varied legal systems. This makes them likely to engage in forensic advisory services for international disputes, M&A due diligence, and regulatory interactions. ([StoneTurn](#))

Key points:

- Number of countries of operation
- Involvement in cross-border transactions
- Exposure to multiple regulatory environments

F. Strategic Expansion & Regulatory Scrutiny

Organisations undergoing mergers, acquisitions, restructuring, or rapid growth often attract regulatory scrutiny and require proactive risk mitigation. This includes forensic due diligence, compliance integration, and regulatory readiness services central to GT China's offering. ([KPMG](#))

Key points:

- M&A or capital market activity
- Regulatory inquiries or compliance reviews
- Public or investor-driven transparency demands

G. Suitability for Long-Term Engagements

Clients with ongoing compliance needs, large portfolios (e.g., PE/VC with multiple portfolio companies), or repeat investigation/dispute work present a higher lifetime value. These clients are likely to generate **recurring forensic advisory needs**, making them strategically critical for GT China's business development. ([StoneTurn](#))

Key points:

- History of repeat service engagement
- Depth of compliance infrastructure needs
- Potential for ongoing advisory relationships

By systematically evaluating potential clients against these relevance metrics, Grant Thornton China can prioritise engagements with organisations that present the highest strategic value, risk exposure, and potential for long-term forensic advisory partnerships in the Chinese market.

3. Understanding Stakeholder Analysis & Power/Interest Grid

3.1 What is the Power/Interest Grid?

The Power/Interest Grid is a stakeholder analysis tool used to classify stakeholders based on their level of **power** and **interest** in a particular engagement or service.

Power refers to a stakeholder's ability to influence decisions, outcomes, or engagement opportunities. In the context of Grant Thornton, this could include decision-making authority, control over budgets, or influence within an organisation.

Interest refers to the level of need or relevance a stakeholder has for Grant Thornton's services, such as audit, risk advisory, fraud investigation, or compliance support.

The grid is divided into four quadrants:

1. **High Power, High Interest** – Key decision-makers who require close engagement and priority focus.
2. **High Power, Low Interest** – Influential stakeholders who should be kept satisfied and engaged strategically.
3. **Low Power, High Interest** – Stakeholders who benefit from GT's services but have limited decision-making authority; they should be kept informed.
4. **Low Power, Low Interest** – Stakeholders with minimal influence and limited engagement requirements.

3.2 Why It Matters for Grant Thornton China

The Power/Interest Grid helps Grant Thornton China identify **high-value business development targets** by focusing on stakeholders who have both decision-making authority and a strong need for professional services. It supports effective **prioritisation of outreach efforts**, ensuring that time and resources are directed toward the most impactful opportunities. Additionally, it enables better **resource allocation** by aligning engagement strategies with stakeholder influence and interest levels, leading to more efficient and targeted client interactions.

3.3 Methodology Used

The methodology begins with identifying relevant stakeholders across client organisations and industries. Each stakeholder is then assessed based on their relative level of power and interest in Grant Thornton's services. These stakeholders are plotted onto the Power/Interest Grid to determine their quadrant placement. Based on this categorisation, insights are interpreted to understand stakeholder importance, and an appropriate engagement strategy is defined for each quadrant to maximise outreach effectiveness and relationship development.

4. Shortlist of Potential Clients

4.1 Shortlist of Multinational Corporations (MNCs)

Met: 10 MNCs

Company Name	Sector	China Presence (City)	Why Relevant to GT Forensic Work	Website
Apple Inc.	Technology	Beijing, Shanghai	Supply-chain fraud risk, regulatory compliance, IP investigations	https://www.apple.com
Microsoft Corporation	Technology	Beijing, Shanghai	Cyber investigations, FCPA, data privacy compliance	https://www.microsoft.com
Siemens AG	Industrial & Engineering	Beijing, Shanghai	Procurement fraud, cross-border investigations	https://www.siemens.com

BASF SE	Chemicals	Shanghai	Environmental compliance, regulatory exposure	https://www.basf.com
General Electric (GE)	Energy & Industrial	Shanghai	Contract disputes, corruption risk	https://www.ge.com
Unilever	FMCG	Shanghai	Distributor fraud, supply-chain investigations	https://www.unilever.com
Shell Plc	Energy	Beijing	ESG compliance, sanctions, regulatory risk	https://www.shell.com
HSBC Holdings Plc	Financial Services	Beijing, Shanghai	AML, sanctions, financial crime investigations	https://www.hsbc.com
Procter & Gamble (P&G)	FMCG	Beijing, Guangzhou	Vendor fraud, internal controls reviews	https://www.pg.com
Pfizer Inc.	Pharmaceuticals	Shanghai	Compliance, clinical trial integrity, bribery risks	https://www.pfizer.com

4.2 Shortlist of Private Equity / Venture Capital Firms

10 PE / VC Firms

Firm Name	Type	China Activity	Why Relevant for GT Forensic Services	Website
Sequoia Capital China	VC	Beijing, Shanghai	Due diligence, portfolio fraud risk	https://www.sequoiacap.com
Hillhouse Capital	PE	Beijing	Valuation disputes, regulatory scrutiny	https://www.hillhousecap.com

KKR	PE	Shanghai	Transaction forensics, post-deal disputes	https://www.kkr.com
Blackstone	PE	Shanghai	Asset tracing, compliance investigations	https://www.blackstone.com
Carlyle Group	PE	Beijing	Anti-corruption, exit risk analysis	https://www.carlyle.com
TPG Capital	PE	Shanghai	Forensic due diligence	https://www.tpg.com
Bain Capital	PE	Shanghai	Financial misstatements, internal fraud	https://www.baincapital.com
Warburg Pincus	PE	Beijing	Cross-border compliance risk	https://www.warburgpincus.com
SoftBank Vision Fund	VC	China Portfolio	Governance and valuation disputes	https://www.softbank.jp/en
GGV Capital	VC	Shanghai	Startup fraud, IP risks	https://www.ggv.com

4.3 Shortlist of International Law Firms with China Presence

20 Law Firms

Law Firm Name	Focus Area	China Offices	Why Relevant to GT	Website
Baker McKenzie	Compliance, Investigations	Beijing, Shanghai	Joint forensic-legal investigations	https://www.bakermckenzie.com
Clifford Chance	Litigation, Regulatory	Beijing, Shanghai	Expert witness & forensic support	https://www.cliffordchance.com
Allen & Overy	Compliance	Shanghai	Financial investigations	https://www.allenoverly.com

Linklaters	Disputes	Beijing, Shanghai	Arbitration forensic support	https://www.linklaters.com
Freshfields Bruckhaus Deringer	Investigations	Beijing	FCPA and regulatory probes	https://www.freshfields.com
Hogan Lovells	Compliance	Beijing	Risk advisory collaboration	https://www.hoganlovells.com
White & Case	Arbitration	Beijing	Asset tracing, disputes	https://www.whitecase.com
Latham & Watkins	Corporate Investigations	Beijing	Transaction forensics	https://www.lw.com
Skadden	Litigation	Beijing	Expert financial analysis	https://www.skadden.com
Norton Rose Fulbright	Compliance	Shanghai	Regulatory risk advisory	https://www.nortonrosefulbright.com
King & Wood Mallesons	Cross-border disputes	Beijing	Local-global forensic cases	https://www.kwm.com
DLA Piper	Compliance	Shanghai	Corporate fraud matters	https://www.dlapiper.com
Herbert Smith Freehills	Arbitration	Shanghai	Dispute forensics	https://www.herbertsmithfreehills.com
Ashurst	Regulatory	Shanghai	Investigations support	https://www.ashurst.com
CMS	Compliance	Beijing	Risk assessments	https://www.cms.law
Debevoise & Plimpton	PE Investigations	Beijing	PE forensic matters	https://www.debevoise.com

Ropes & Gray	Financial Crime	Shanghai	AML investigations	https://www.ropesgray.com
WilmerHale	Regulatory	Beijing	Government investigations	https://www.wilmerhale.com
Covington & Burling	Compliance	Beijing	Anti-corruption cases	https://www.cov.com
Paul Hastings	Litigation	Shanghai	Dispute advisory	https://www.paulhastings.com

4.4 Relevance Justification Summary

The selection of the shortlisted MNCs, PE/VC firms, and law firms was based on the following strategic considerations, in tune with GT Grant Thornton Forensic & Investigation Services:

- Indeed, increased regulatory scrutiny in mainland China exposes multinationals to compliance and anti-corruption and ESG risks ([pwc.com](https://www.pwc.com)).
- PE & CV firms calls for strong forensic due diligence for private equity and VC firms to handle the issues of valuation, governance, and exit risks in complicated markets ([ey.com](https://www.ey.com)).
- Many law firms retain forensic expertise for expert witness testimony, asset tracing, and dispute quantification, leading to good referral opportunities.
- PRC's evolving data protection, AML, and sanctions regimes increase the demand for independent forensic investigations ([deloitte.com](https://www.deloitte.com)).
- This bolsters exposure to cross-border operations, including FCPA, UK Bribery Act concerns, and multi-jurisdictional enforcement matters where GT has strong global credentials.
- GT's strength lies in their mid-market and multinational experience, positioning them competitively against Big Four firms for cost-effective and high-quality forensic solutions.

These shortlisted organizations are positioned as strong business development opportunities for Grant Thornton's forensic practice, which provide sustained growth in the China and Asia-Pacific market.

5. Application: Power/Interest Grid for Shortlisted Clients

The shortlisted Multinational Corporations, Private equity firms, and international law firms were evaluated using a Power-Interest framework aligned with Grand Thornton's Forensic Advisory objectives.

- **Power:** how much influence a client or stakeholder has over starting, approving, and shaping an engagement with Grant Thornton.
- **Interest:** how strong the client's need is for Grant Thornton's forensic, compliance, and investigation services.

Power was evaluated based on:

- Decision-making authority over advisory engagements
- Size of operations and financial influence
- Control over budgets and external advisors
- Ability to initiate long-term, multi-service engagements

Interest was evaluated based on:

- Exposure to regulatory, compliance, and fraud risks in China
- Need for forensic investigations, dispute support, or compliance advisory.
- Frequency of cross-border transactions, M&A, or litigation
- Likelihood of recurring forensic and investigative requirements

Scores were assessed using the relevance metrics defined in **Section 2** and the client justification in **Section 4**. Based on this evaluation, each shortlisted client was placed into one of the four Power–Interest quadrants:

1. **High Power, High Interest**
2. **High Power, Low Interest**
3. **Low Power, High Interest**
4. **Low Power, Low Interest**



A. High Power – High Interest (Priority Targets/Manage Closely)

These clients have strong decision-making authority and a high demand for forensic advisory services as a result of regulatory scrutiny, cross-border exposure, and compliance risks.

Examples:

- Apple Inc.
- Microsoft Corporation
- HSBC Holdings
- Blackstone
- KKR
- Carlyle Group

Engagement Strategy:

- Proactive relationship management
- Dedicated forensic advisory pitches
- Long-term retainer-based or multi-service engagements

B. High Power – Low Interest (Keep Satisfied)

These clients have strong influence and resources but may not have immediate forensic needs.

Examples:

- Siemens AG
- Shell Plc

Engagement Strategy:

- Periodic engagement and thought leadership
- Compliance updates and regulatory briefings
- Relationship maintenance for future needs

C. Low Power – High Interest (Keep Informed)

These stakeholders actively require forensic support but do not independently control significant engagement decisions. Law firms and some VC firms fall into this category.

Examples:

- Baker McKenzie
- Clifford Chance
- Freshfields

- Sequoia Capital China
- GGV Capital

Engagement Strategy:

- Strong referral partnerships
- Joint investigations and expert witness collaboration
- Knowledge sharing and co-branded insights

D. Low Power – Low Interest (Monitor)

These entities have limited influence and relatively lower immediate forensic requirements.

Examples:

- CMS
- Linklaters

Engagement Strategy:

- Minimal engagement
- Monitor for changes in regulatory exposure or disputes.

Key Takeaways from the Grid

The Power–Interest Grid highlights that **large MNCs and PE firms represent the highest-priority targets** for Grant Thornton China due to their combined influence and consistent forensic needs. Meanwhile, **international law firms act as strategic enablers**, providing referral-driven engagement opportunities as opposed to direct revenue leadership. This structured mapping ensures focused allocation of development efforts and directly complements the engagement strategies developed in subsequent weeks.

6. Insights from Relevance Metrics & Stakeholder Grid

1. Patterns Observed

The application of relevance metrics against the Power/Interest Grid reveals three distinct strategic patterns for Grant Thornton China's Forensic Advisory practice in the 2025 landscape:

- **The Convergence of Digital & Operational Risk:**
Traditionally, forensic needs were siloed (e.g., financial fraud vs. cyber breach). The

analysis shows that high-value targets (Apple, Microsoft, Siemens) now face "hybrid risks" where supply chain fraud often involves data privacy violations. The 2025 legislative agenda, particularly the *Network Data Security Management Measures*, has forced a convergence: clients with high "China Operational Complexity" almost always have high "Industry Risk Exposure" due to data handling compliance. ([china-briefing](#))

- **The "Beijing-Shanghai" Centralization Paradox:**

While "Global Footprint" and "Operational Complexity" suggest widespread risks across China's manufacturing provinces, the *decision-making power* for forensic engagement is overwhelmingly concentrated in Beijing (Regulatory HQ) and Shanghai (Commercial HQ). The metrics confirm that while the fraud occurs in the provinces, the engagement is won in these two hubs. Clients without a "Physical office in Shanghai/Beijing" (Metric D) lack the centralized compliance function necessary to commission high-value forensic work. ([grantthornton](#))

- **Regulatory Scrutiny as the Primary Trigger:**

Across all sectors, "Compliance Pressure Level" (Metric C) is the strongest predictor of interest. Companies subject to recent 2025 legislative updates—such as the new audit measures for personal information protection—show a higher immediate need for forensic readiness than those in less regulated sectors, regardless of their revenue size. ([connections.nortonrosefulbright](#))

2. High-Priority Client Categories

The grid segments potential clients into three distinct tiers of value:

- **Tier 1: The "Anchor" MNCs (High Power / High Interest)**

- **Profile:** Industrial, Tech, and Pharma giants (e.g., Siemens, Pfizer, Apple).
- **Value Proposition:** These entities face the "Perfect Storm" of risks: complex supply chains susceptible to procurement fraud, high IP theft exposure, and intense regulatory scrutiny from both China (PIPL) and home jurisdictions (FCPA/UK Bribery Act). They possess the budget to retain Grant Thornton for long-term "prevention and detection" retainers rather than just reactive crisis management. ([grantthornton](#))

- **Tier 2: The "Deal-Driven" PE/VC Firms (High Power / Variable Interest)**

- **Profile:** KKR, Blackstone, Sequoia China.
- **Value Proposition:** Their interest is cyclical, spiking during M&A transactions or exits. However, the current 2025 trend of "IP misappropriation as a survival strategy" among struggling manufacturers makes forensic due diligence critical for these investors to protect their portfolio valuations. ([mondaq](#))

- **Tier 3: The "Strategic Channel" Law Firms (Low Power / High Interest)**

- **Profile:** Baker McKenzie, Clifford Chance.
- **Value Proposition:** While they lack the "Power" to approve large budgets independently, they are the gatekeepers to high-stakes litigation and arbitration. They are essential "Force Multipliers" for Grant Thornton, providing access to clients who are already in crisis mode (High Interest). ([grantthornton](#))

3. How the Grid Helped in Ranking

The Power/Interest Grid provided a necessary filter to move from a "list of big companies" to a "strategic target list":

- **Resource Allocation:** It filtered out High Power/Low Interest entities (e.g., stable, state-linked firms with entrenched auditors) that would consume business development resources with low probability of conversion.
- **Service Matching:** It clarified that "High Interest" clients with lower power (Law Firms) require a *partnership* approach (joint marketing, expert witness support) rather than a direct *sales* approach.
- **Revenue Quality:** It highlighted that while Law Firms provide *volume* (number of cases), MNCs provide *value* (size of retainer). This allows GT China to balance its portfolio between steady operational work (MNCs) and high-margin crisis work (Law Firms/PE).

4. Key Risks Common Across Industries (2025 Outlook)

Regardless of the sector, three specific risk vectors are universally relevant to the shortlisted clients:

- **Supply Chain & Procurement Fraud:** As economic headwinds pressure local manufacturers, the risk of "quality fading" (substituting cheaper materials) and kickback schemes in procurement has risen significantly.([gembah](#))
- **Data Security & PIPL Compliance:** With the 2025 updates to the Cybersecurity Law, the forensic audit of data flows is no longer an IT issue but a legal compliance necessity. This is a shared risk for every entity from Apple (Tech) to Pfizer (Pharma patient data).(optilogic)
- **Intellectual Property (IP) Misappropriation:** The risk of local partners or employees "lifting and shifting" IP to competing entities is a critical concern, particularly for PE firms valuing technology-heavy portfolios.(mondaq)

5. Comparative Analysis: MNC vs. PE/VC vs. Law Firms

Feature	Multinational Corporations (MNCs)	Private Equity / Venture Capital (PE/VC)	International Law Firms
Primary Driver	Operational Continuity & Compliance. MNCs are driven by the need to keep the "machine" running without regulatory interruption or reputational damage.	Transaction Value & ROI. PE/VCs are driven by the entry (buying clean assets) and exit (selling validated assets) phases of the investment lifecycle.	Legal Defensibility. Law firms are driven by the need for evidence that stands up in court or arbitration (e.g., CIETAC hearings).

Key Risk Focus	Internal Controls & Fraud. Focus is on procurement fraud, FCPA violations, and employee misconduct (e.g., kickbacks).	Valuation & Hidden Liabilities. Focus is on financial statement manipulation, off-balance-sheet liabilities, and IP ownership validity.	Litigation Support & Asset Tracing. Focus is on quantifying damages, tracing embezzled assets, and expert testimony.
Engagement Model	Retainer / Recurring. continuous internal audit support, annual compliance reviews, and whistleblower hotline management.	Project-Based / Cyclical. Intense, short-term engagements linked to specific deals (Pre-deal Due Diligence) or post-deal disputes.	Referral / Partnership. Collaborative model where GT acts as the "technical expert" alongside the firm's "legal counsel."
Decision Power	Centralized Corporate. Decisions usually require sign-off from Regional Compliance Heads (APAC) or Global General Counsel.	Investment Committee. Decisions are fast but ruthless; driven by the deal team and investment committee.	Partner-Led. Individual partners often have autonomy to select forensic experts for their specific cases.
GT Relevance	High. Fits GT's strength in handling complex, cross-border operational nuances and long-term "governance" partnerships(grantthornton).	Medium-High. Critical for "Red Flag" reports where GT's agility allows for faster turnaround than Big 4 competitors(grantthornton).	High. GT's specific expertise in "Corporate Intelligence" and "Asset Tracing" directly supports their litigation strategies(grantthornton).

7. Implications for Grant Thornton China

Strategic, Market-Driven Analysis

1. Business Development Opportunities

Grant Thornton China operates in an environment characterized by intensified regulatory enforcement, rising financial crime complexity, and increasing cross-border business activity. China's regulators continue to strengthen oversight across financial reporting, anti-corruption,

data governance, and ESG compliance, creating sustained demand for forensic and risk advisory services.

Multinational corporations operating in China face heightened exposure to fraud, sanctions, and compliance breaches, while Chinese enterprises expanding internationally require advisory support aligned with global governance standards. This positions Grant Thornton China to capture both inbound and outbound advisory mandates, reinforcing its role as a trusted risk advisor rather than a traditional assurance provider.

Market evidence indicates the Chinese forensic accounting market is experiencing strong growth driven by regulatory pressure and corporate governance reform.

2. Service Lines with Highest Demand

Demand is increasingly concentrated in high-value, insight-driven service lines:

Forensic & Investigation Services: Fraud detection, misconduct investigations, financial statement manipulation reviews, and regulatory response support remain core growth drivers.

Compliance & Risk Advisory: Anti-bribery, anti-money laundering (AML), sanctions compliance, and ESG-related control frameworks are expanding rapidly.

Dispute & Litigation Support: Arbitration, expert testimony, damages quantification, and contract dispute analysis are increasingly sought as commercial disputes become more complex.

Industry research confirms that fraud investigation and compliance advisory represent the fastest-growing segments within forensic services in China and Asia-Pacific.

3. Long-Term Client Engagement Potential

Forensic engagements increasingly function as strategic entry points into long-term advisory relationships. Clients initially engage Grant Thornton China for reactive investigations, but these engagements often reveal systemic weaknesses in governance, controls, and data integrity.

This creates natural progression into multi-year mandates covering remediation, internal controls redesign, continuous monitoring, and board-level risk advisory. As organizations move from incident response to prevention and resilience, Grant Thornton China can embed itself within clients' risk management ecosystems, supporting stable recurring revenue and higher client lifetime value.

Professional services trends indicate that firms offering integrated forensic and risk advisory solutions achieve stronger client retention and deeper account penetration.

4. Scalability of Forensic Services

The scalability of forensic services is significantly enhanced through technology-enabled delivery models. Advanced data analytics, AI-driven transaction testing, and standardized investigative methodologies allow Grant Thornton China to scale services across industries without proportional increases in cost or headcount.

Modular forensic offerings enable flexible deployment for both mid-market companies and large multinationals, while centralized analytics hubs improve efficiency and consistency. This scalable model supports sustainable growth and strengthens competitive positioning in a market where speed, accuracy, and cost-effectiveness are increasingly critical.

Market analysis highlights technology adoption as a key factor driving scalability and margin expansion in forensic accounting services globally and in China.

5. How Week-3 Outputs Directly Support the Week-4 Retention Strategy

Week-3 outputs—risk diagnostics, forensic analytics, and investigative findings—provide evidence-based insights that go beyond surface-level issues. These outputs identify root causes, control deficiencies, and structural risks, creating a compelling business case for continued engagement.

In Week-4, these insights are strategically leveraged to propose targeted remediation, governance enhancement, and continuous monitoring solutions. This transition from diagnosis to execution transforms short-term investigative work into retained advisory relationships, directly supporting client retention, cross-selling, and long-term value creation.

This insight-to-retention model aligns with best practices in professional services, where data-driven diagnostics underpin sustainable client relationships.

8. Conclusion

Week-3 consolidated earlier research into a structured client-targeting approach for Grant Thornton China by combining relevance metrics with the Power/Interest Grid. This enabled a clear evaluation of potential clients based on regulatory exposure, operational complexity in

China, and suitability for long-term forensic engagements, shifting the focus from broad identification to strategic prioritisation.

The analysis highlighted high-value MNCs and PE/VC firms as priority targets due to their decision-making power and recurring compliance and investigation needs, while international law firms emerged as critical referral and collaboration partners. This balanced shortlist strengthens Grant Thornton China's business development pipeline by aligning client selection with risk intensity, influence, and engagement potential.

Overall, Week-3 provides a robust foundation for future action by improving prioritisation, resource allocation, and strategic focus. The insights generated directly support Week-4 outreach and retention planning, enabling Grant Thornton China to pursue targeted, high-impact engagements and build sustainable long-term client relationships.

APPENDICES

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Thank You!
End of Report